

A man in a brown jacket and grey hoodie is looking at his smartphone in a gym. He has white headphones around his neck. In the background, a woman is also in the gym, looking down. The scene is lit with warm, golden light.

Cloud Native Copenhagen meetup

Unboxing Digital Sovereignty

What does it take to become digital sovereign?

Agenda

- **Digital Sovereignty unboxed**
- **A common language**
- **Creating overview**
- **Ability to Respond**
- **Technological Leadership**
- **Opportunities**
- **Key Take-aways**

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Optimum



1

Digital Sovereignty Unboxed

- *What does it mean for an organization*



International Criminal Court (ICC) Prosecutor Karim Khan attends an interview with Reuters in The Hague, Netherlands, Jan. 16, 2025. File photo by Piroshka van de Wouw/Reuters

Trump's sanctions on ICC's chief prosecutor have halted tribunal's work, officials and lawyers say

Microsoft, for example, cancelled Khan's email address, forcing the prosecutor to move to Proton Mail, a Swiss email provider, ICC staffers said. His bank accounts in his home country of the U.K. have been blocked.

Microsoft did not respond to a request for comment.

Why are we here today?

Digital sovereignty is more relevant than ever.

Broadcom's VMware acquisition explained: The impact on your IT strategy

Since Broadcom's acquisition of VMware, some clients are seeing a cost increase ranging from 150% to 1,250% for the same services.

Kommunerne er dybt afhængige af Microsoft, og deres udgifter stiger og stiger

I 2018 betalte danske kommuner mindst 313 millioner kroner til Microsoft, og i 2023 ligger tallet på omkring 538 millioner kroner. En stigning på over 70 procent.

Digital sovereignty on organizational level

Digital sovereignty for an organization refers to the organization's ability to **maintain full control, autonomy, and self-determination over its digital assets, data, processes, and infrastructure.**

In practice, this means:

1. Data control
2. Technological independence
3. Security autonomy
4. Strategic self-determination
5. Regulatory compliance
6. Vendor management
7. Digital resilience

At its core, **Digital Sovereignty** is being in control and having the ability to respond.



2

A Common Language

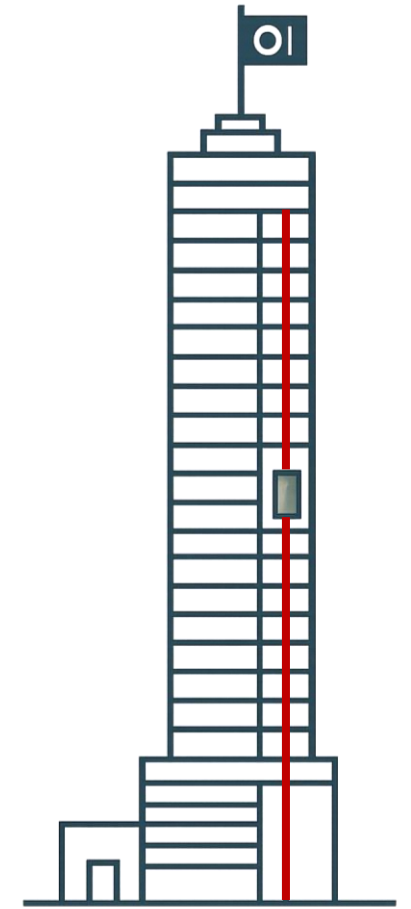
- Shared understanding and point of reference

The Architecture Elevator

The elevator gives a **common language to agree which layer of abstraction**.

The Architecture Elevator creates cohesion from strategic to operational level enabling Digital Sovereignty to be part of the design and decision process along with security and compliance.

Floor	Horizon	Stakeholder	Business layer	Digital layer
7 Strategic	2-5 years	- Top management - Enterprise Architecture	- Business Strategy - Business Vision	- IT Strategy - Architecture vision
6 Tactical	1-2 years	- ART management - Domain Architects	- Capabilities - Epics	- Technical capabilities - Information objects
5 Detailed tactical	Quarters	- ART Team - Solution Architects	- Requirement - Business Processes - Features	- Solution architecture - Data model - Infrastructure design
1-4 Operational	Day to Months	- Product Owner - Team Architects - Developers	- Tasks - Use Stories - Acceptance criteria	C4 diagrams detailing levels 1 to 3 (Container, Component Code)



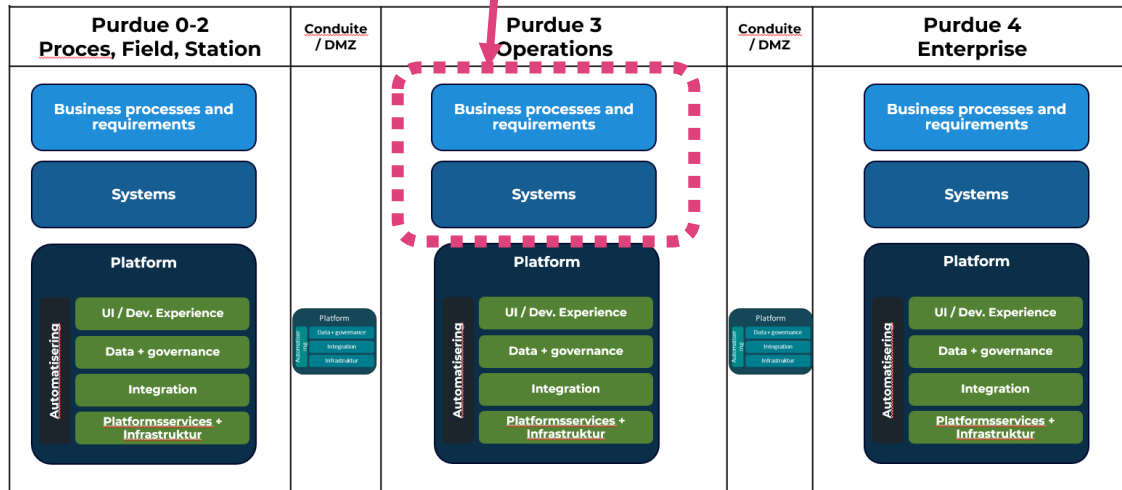
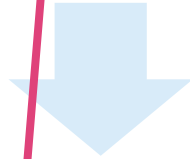
Architectural Map

A tool for navigating the IT landscape

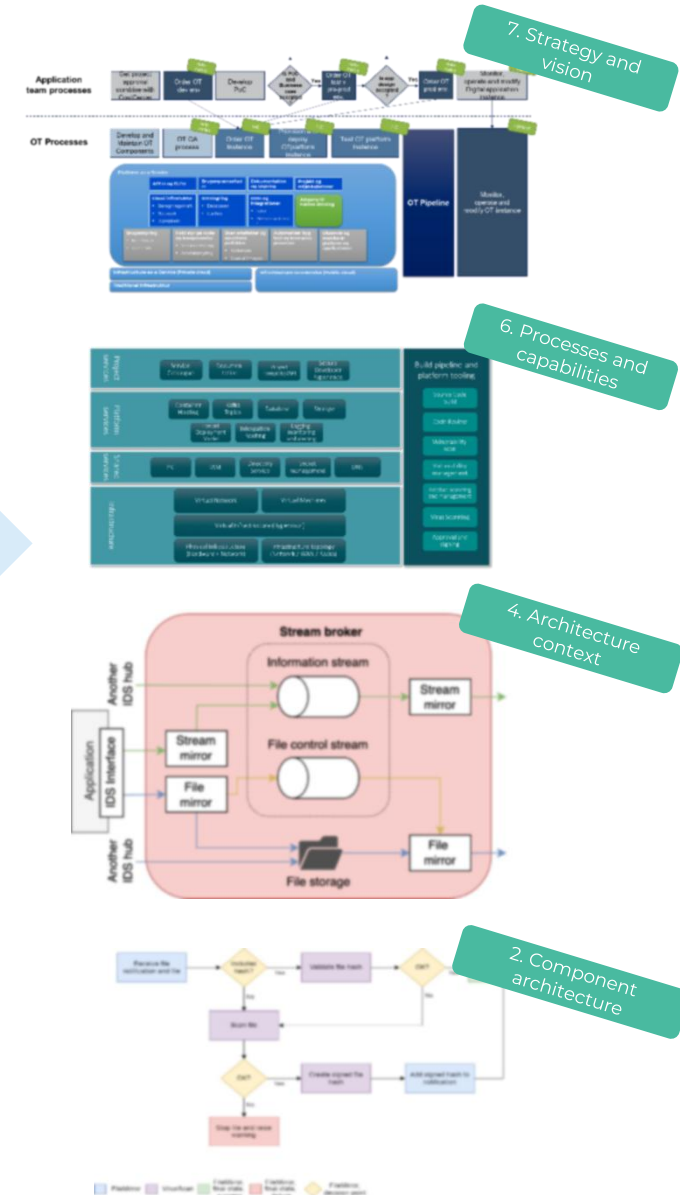
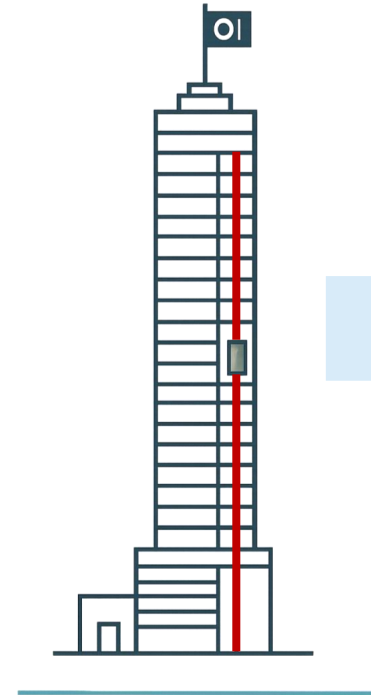
- Provides a **shared focus and a common frame of reference**.
- Makes it **explicit** what is in **scope and focus**, helping drive progress toward defined goals.
- Also clarifies which details are **intentionally omitted** - not forgotten but consciously deferred.
- Strengthens **coherence, alignment**, and **governance**. Especially valuable in today's diverse IT landscapes, combining legacy, PaaS, IaaS, SaaS, BYOD, and more.
- Supports stakeholder **alignment** through a clear and accessible architectural overview.



Architecture Map



Architecture Elevator



A decorative background featuring a series of thin, orange, wavy lines that sweep across the top and bottom of the slide, creating a sense of motion and depth.

3

Overview and Insights

- From Data to Insights

Trends, value adds and solutions

Facing the complications of...

Fast changes in digital market conditions.

Aging technology stacks are pushing large systems modernizations

Compliance and cyber security requirements are rising (NIS2, CRA, DORA, ETC)

AI assisted decision support and automation (Hype-curve)

How can we...?

Faster processes and new customer services

Lower cost and risk

Always secure and compliant

Scalable, flexible and robust solutions.

By using...?

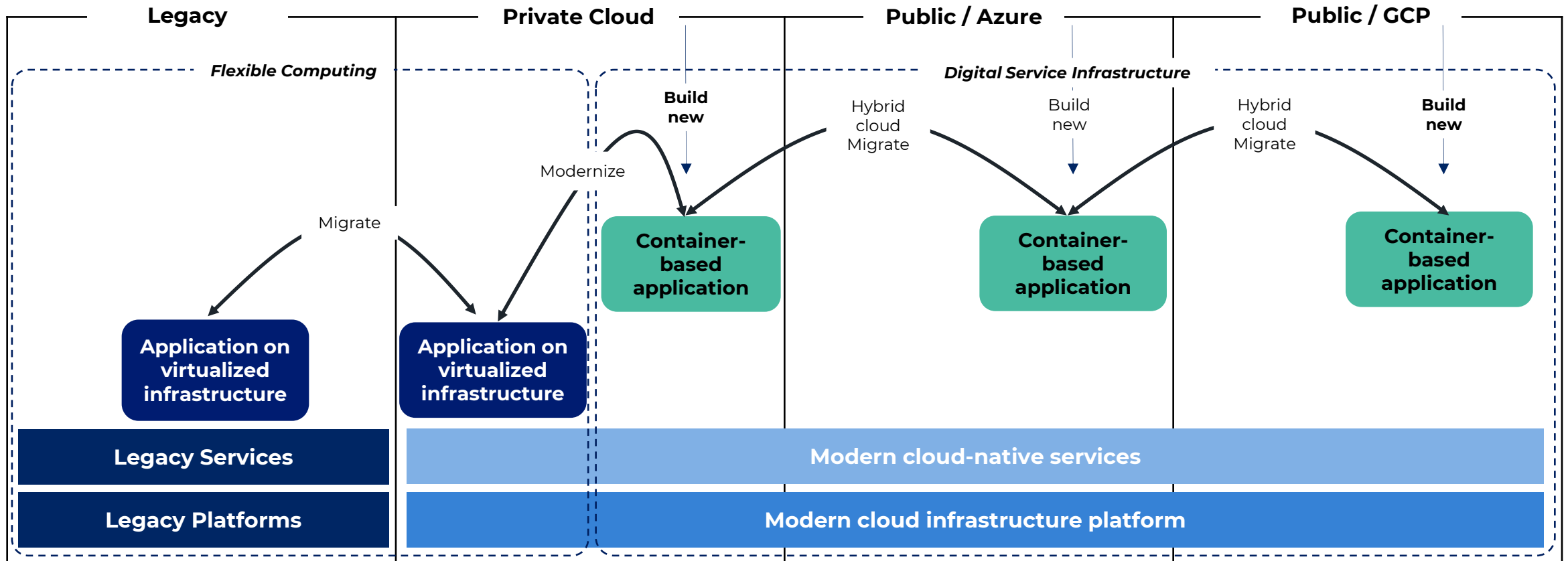


New and migrated applications based on...

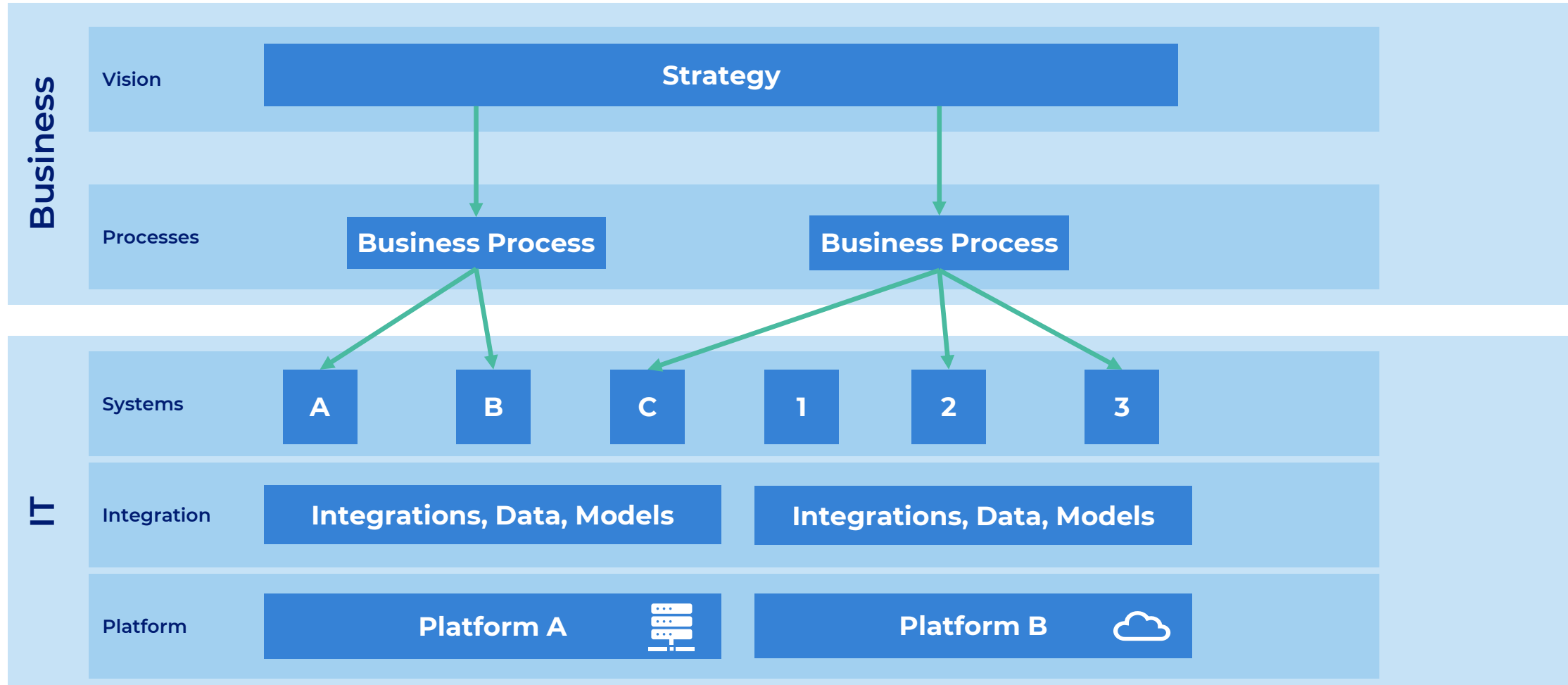
Platform-as-a-Service
"Use as building blocks"

Infrastructure-as-a-Service
"Use as operating platform"

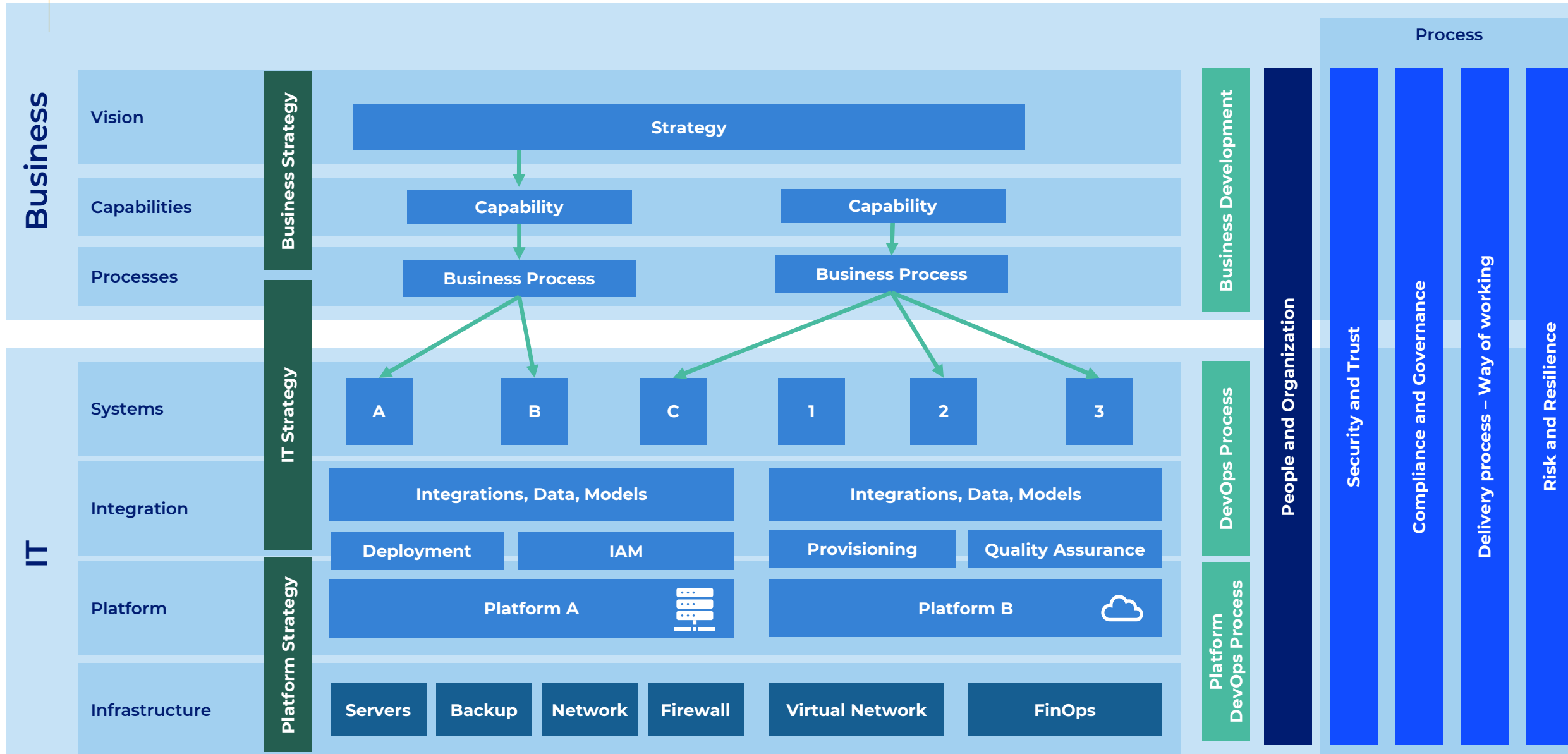
Flexibility and scalability in the systems landscape



The classic overview of a target architecture



A holistic target architecture – Digital Sovereignty





4

Ability to React and Respond

- From Insight to Actions and Flexibility

Ability to React and Respond

There are processes... and then there are *processes*

- **Some processes keep the lights on, ie. Runtime processes.**
- **Others define how we shape our future, ie. Designtime processes.**
- **Compliance might tick the box.** But sovereignty asks *who wrote the form?*
- **You do not inherit sovereignty you design for it.**
- Digital sovereignty goes **beyond IT - it's a strategic goal, process and organizational design. And is it knowledge management.**

Consider the case of 'Island Mode'.

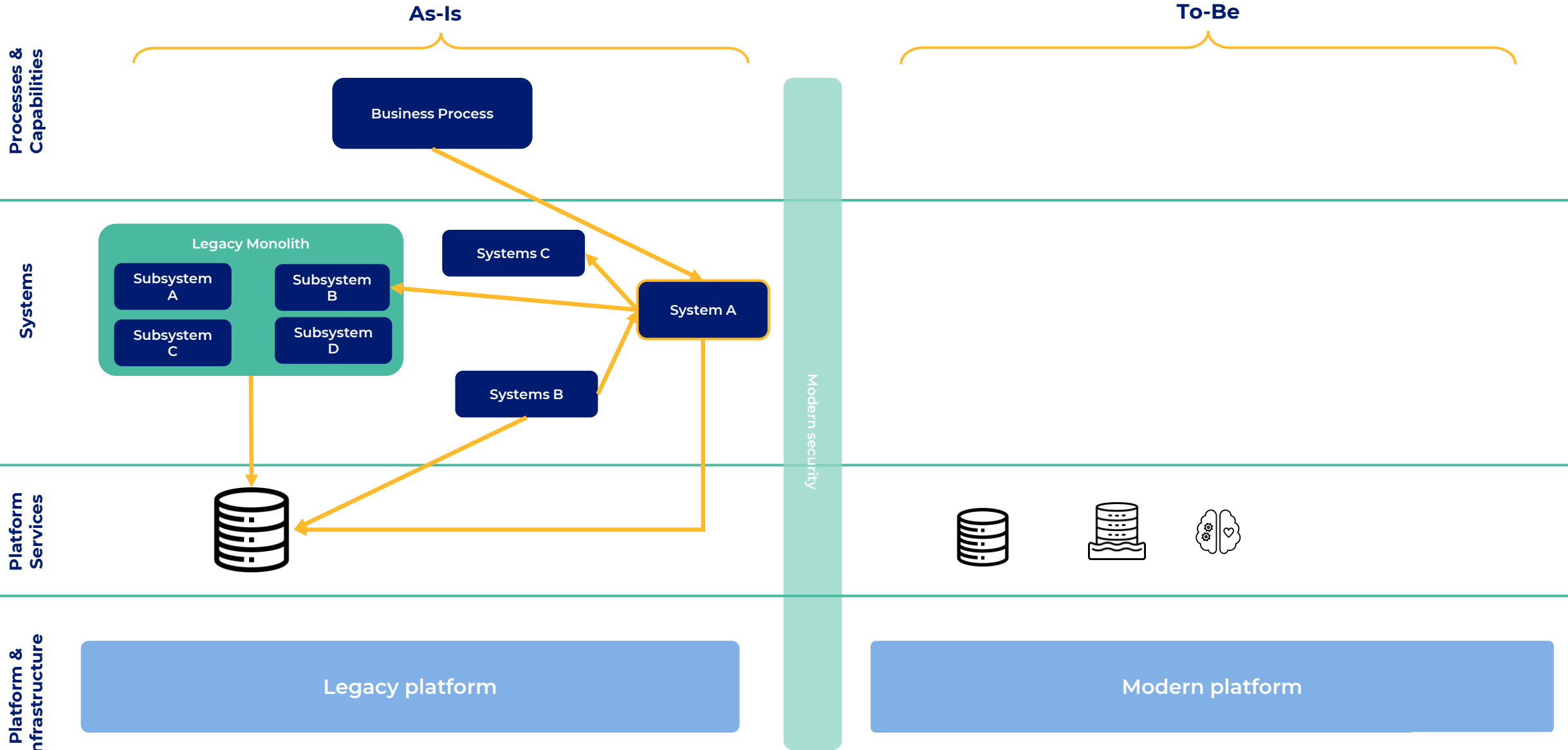
Cases

- **#1: Digital Sovereignty During Runtime.**
Being able to move when you have to.
- **#2: Digital sovereignty During Design Time**
Easy choices leads to a difficult road and vice versa.



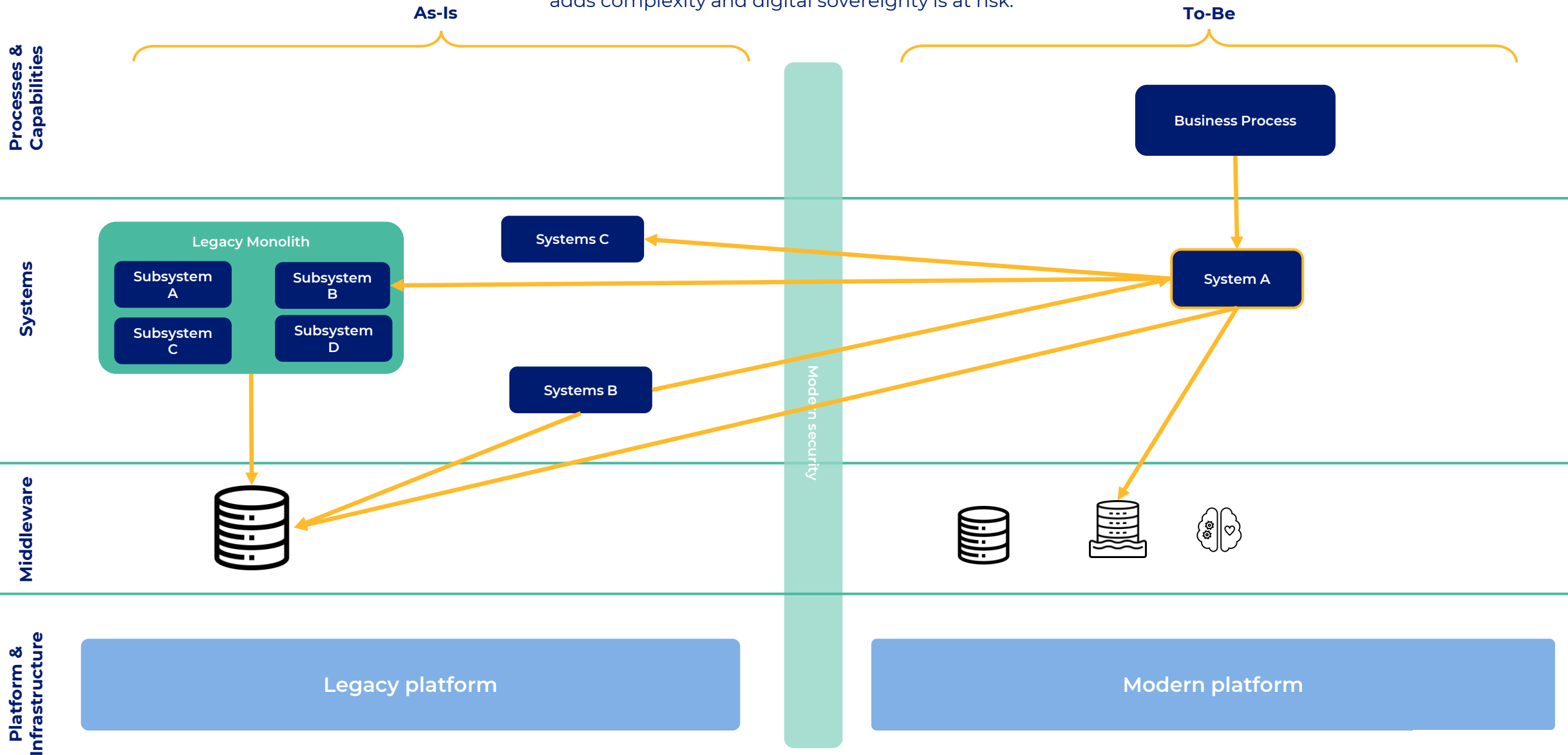
#1 Digital Sovereignty during Runtime

Transformations without a clear strategy and holistic approach, causes tightly couples' platforms and adds complexity and digital sovereignty is at risk.



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#2 Digital Sovereignty during Design Time

Vendor Locking

Without a holistic and active approach, the business becomes locked to specific services and vendors, and the digital sovereignty is at risk.

Processes &
Capabilities

A Business Process

Legacy Monolith

Subsystem

Subsystem

Subsystem

Subsystem

Systems

Systems

Systems

Systems

Platform Services



Platform &
Infrastructure

Public Cloud Provider
PaaS

SaaS Provider

Digital Sovern platform

Obtaining digital sovereignty needs careful consideration at every level.

A Business Process

System

System A

System



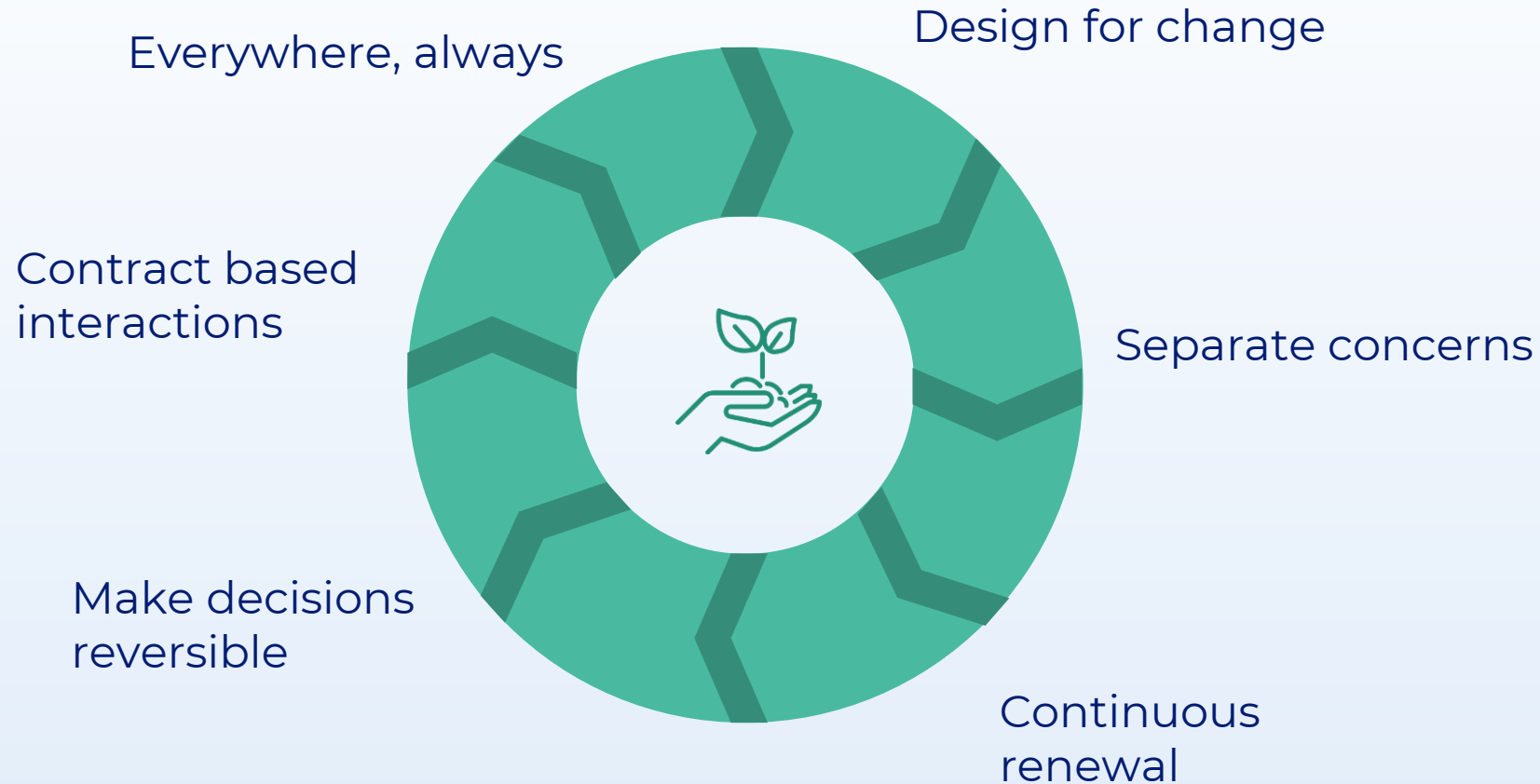
Hypervisor / Hybrid cloud

Public Cloud
Provider

Public Cloud
Provider

Private Cloud

The Evergreen principle



Evergreen is a strategic commitment to continuous renewal and anticipation of change.

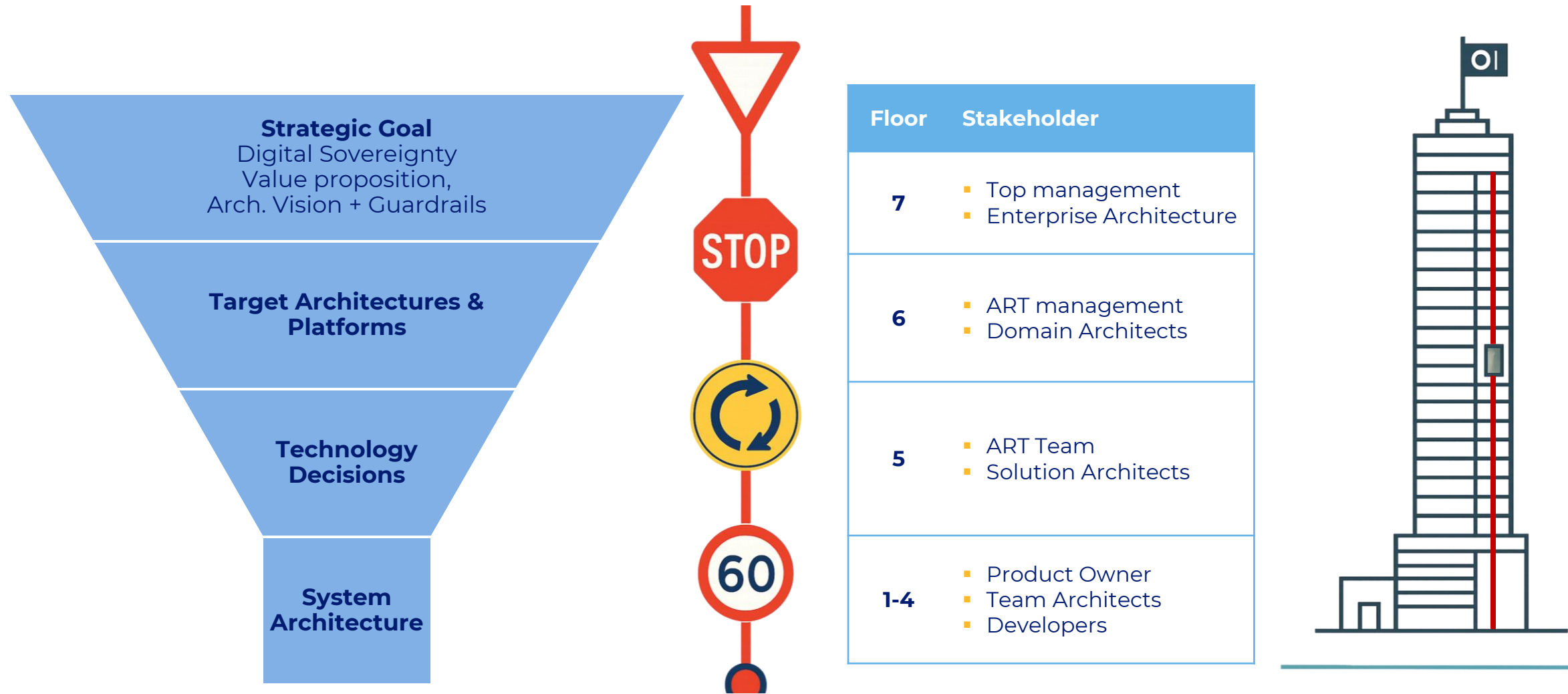
The background of the slide features a series of thin, orange, wavy lines that create a sense of motion and depth. These lines are concentrated in the upper and lower portions of the slide, framing a central dark blue horizontal band.

5

Technological Leadership at *All* Levels

- *Strategy, Execution, and Culture*

Technological Leadership, mandate and QA at *All* Levels



Why leadership on all is important

The devil is in the details - and he's got beachfront property 🏖️.

Ignore the details, and bigger picture, and you rent space in the devil's summerhouse.

- **Each floor influences the surrounding floors. Responsiveness lives in the space between layers - and so does trouble.**
- **Being on multiple floors simultaneously greatly increases the risk of choices which gives long term struggles.**
- **Responsiveness is not about speed alone - it's about knowing where you're standing when the floor below shifts. Or a good decision becomes a bad decision and needs to be reversed.**





6

Opportunities by Digital Sovereignty

- Unlocking potential through control

Key takeaways

At its core, **Digital Sovereignty** is being in control and having the ability to respond.



Strategic technical leadership is fundamental to connect strategy, design, and delivery.

It requires overview and the power to execute on all levels



A common language enables coherence.

The architecture elevator and maps create shared understanding across layers.

Always be able to answer: “Why are we doing this?” and “what’s in it for me?”



Sovereignty unlocks flexibility and leverage.

It enables faster reactions, better negotiations, and

There are hidden value add in smarter cost control and effective processes.



Sovereignty is more than just IT

True control spans contracts, governance, and design principles.

The real work is in designing the right processes and organization.



The evergreen principle is key.

Strategic renewal, reversibility, and modularity support long-term autonomy.

The only constant is change. Why not make it an advantage?

Wrap-up



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Digital Sovereignty Unboxed

- *What Does It Mean?*

A Common Language

- *Shared understanding and point of reference*

Overview and Insights

- *From Data to Insights*

Ability to React and Respond

- *From Insight, to Actions and Flexibility*

Technological Leadership at All Levels

- *Strategy, Execution, and Culture*

Opportunities by Digital Sovereignty

- *Unlocking Potential Through Control*